Bicycles

The invention of the bicycle was the biggest advance in personal transportation since the domestication of the horse. Bicycles are still one of the most energy-efficient forms of transportation.

Transmitting power

A bicycle rider's muscle power is transmitted to the back wheel by a chain connected, via levers called cranks, to the pedals. The rider can pedal efficiently only within a narrow speed range. Gears enable the rider to stay within this range by turning the back wheel faster or slower for the same pedaling rate.

